est Brahmin face in the state capital (where, incidentally, Brahmin voters are in significant numbers). She had begun campaigning even before she was officially named a candidate, just days after she turned 25 on January 4. "I have been active in this constituency for the last one year," she told INDIA TODAY. "There's huge anti-incumbency against the present BJP MLA. People want change."

In Rath, Hamirpur, the SP has given a ticket to local girl Chandrawati Varma, a sports enthusiast who used to work as a fitness trainer in Hyderabad just months ago. A video of her dancing with friends on the song *Ole Ole* went viral on social media recently, drawing the same poison darts from BJP supporters as Archana Gautam, the Congress candidate in Hastinapur, after her bikini pics were posted online. The SP stood by Varma, calling it her personal affair.

The BSP showed signs of catching the infection when it appointed Seema Kushwaha, a Supreme Court lawyer who represented the victims in the Nirbhaya and Hathras rape cases, as a national spokesperson.

In neighbouring Uttarakhand, the 'revenge campaign' of two daughters is drawing some attention. In Kotdwar, the BJP's Ritu Khanduri Bhushan is taking on Surendra Singh Negi, the man who defeated her father, former CM B.C. Khanduri, in 2012. And Anupama Rawat is facing off against the BJP's Swami Yatishwaranand in Haridwar (Rural)—the one who proved to be dad Harish Rawat's nemesis in 2017. ■

–with Prashant Srivastava, Anilesh S. Mahajan, Kiran D. Tare and Ashish Misra

poaching their MLAs. Goa Forward Party (GFP) chief **Vijai Sardesai** is putting his faith in divinity though. He marched his candidates to Mapusa deity Bodageshwar to pledge that they'll never join the BJP in their lifetime. Being an unforgiving sort, Bodageshwar does not take kindly to a broken pledge. Those who dare do so, do not live long. Ergo, long live GFP. ■

FOCUS
AUTO

#BeTheBetterGuy
A Road Safety Initiative

HYUNDAI Moving the world Together
A CSR initiative by Hyundai Motor India Foundation
X INDIA TODAY GROUP

India Today Group and Hyundai Motor India Foundation with a shared vision have come together to work towards a common goal of making Indian roads safer. The campaign is motivated towards raising civic sense within Indians, communicating road safety concerns to road users and bringing about an organic change in the world's 2nd most populous country.

The driving force behind this campaign is creating awareness about road safety and driving etiquettes. It is the lackadaisical attitude towards these two factors by drivers themselves that causes most accidents.

SAFETY MATTERS

The thrill of speed can be exhilarating, but it's important not to take the consequences of over-speeding lightly. It is imperative that you stick to the speed rules. The fear of getting pulled over and ticketed by speed cameras and interceptor patrol cars is enough to make even the most stubborn driver think twice before they break any laws.



Vehicle knowledge is also an important part of the equation when it comes to preventing speeding. To be a great driver, you need to know how your car handles and accelerates. Learning the optimal braking performance of each individual vehicle is just as important so that when someone messes up or makes an error in judgment while driving, you'll have time enough on hand to act before impact. You need an intuitive grasp on when it's better (or worse) time for you to brake, accelerate or change lanes.

Motoring is a joy and living life in the slow lane should be encouraged. So, next time you hear that chime go off at 80 or 120 kmph, take note of how much fun it can really feel when we're not speeding up.



